

Day 27 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Salient Features of the Indian Constitution

READING MATERIAL

Covers the Constitution's defining structural characteristics — its length, its federal-unitary blend, and a cluster of real exam facts about specific Schedules, Articles, and landmark Supreme Court cases. Distinct from the Preamble topic (a4-constitution-preamble-overview), which covers the Preamble's text and amendment history specifically.

Q: What makes the Indian Constitution notable for its length, and how has this changed since 1949?

A: It is the longest written constitution of any sovereign country in the world. Originally (1949) it had 395 Articles, 22 Parts, and 8 Schedules; through amendments it has grown to roughly 448 Articles, 25 Parts, and 12 Schedules today (exact counts shift slightly as articles are added/repealed).

Q: Is India's Constitution federal or unitary in character?

A: A blend of both — often called 'quasi-federal' (a term associated with constitutional scholar K.C. Wheare): federal in FORM (a written, supreme constitution; division of powers between Centre and States; bicameral Parliament; independent judiciary) but unitary in SPIRIT, with a single integrated judiciary, single citizenship, a flexible amendment process for many provisions, Centrally-appointed Governors, All India Services (IAS/IPS/IFS), and strong emergency powers that can centralise power temporarily.

Q: What form of government does the Constitution establish at the Centre?

A: A parliamentary form of government: the President is the nominal/constitutional head of state, while real executive authority rests with the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers, who are collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha (the directly elected house).

Q: Where did India borrow its Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP) and Judicial Review from?

A: The Directive Principles of State Policy were adopted from the Irish Constitution. Judicial Review (the power of courts to strike down unconstitutional laws) is an important contribution borrowed from the Constitution of the USA (per a real TNPSC question).

Q: Real exam: What does Part XI of the Constitution describe?

A: Centre-State relations (legislative, administrative, and financial relations between the Union and the States) — not to be confused with the Union Government (covered in Part V) or State Government (Part VI).

Q: Real exam: Which Schedule lists the subjects assigned to Panchayats, and what is NOT included in it?

A: The Eleventh Schedule specifies the powers, authority, and responsibilities of Panchayats, listing 29 subjects (agriculture, minor irrigation, social forestry, rural housing, drinking water, health and sanitation, public distribution system, etc.). 'Prevention of cruelty to animals' is NOT one of the 29 items — a real exam question tests this exclusion specifically, so don't assume every plausible-sounding welfare/animal-related subject is on the list.

Q: Real exam: Which Schedule of the Constitution deals with languages, and what was added to it by the 21st Amendment Act, 1967?

A: The Eighth Schedule lists the officially recognised languages of India. The 21st Constitutional Amendment Act, 1967 added Sindhi to this Schedule.

Q: Real exam: To whom is the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India responsible, and who chaired the Official Language Commission of 1955?

A: The CAG is responsible only to Parliament (not to the President or Prime Minister individually) — their audit reports are submitted to the President/Governors but are placed before Parliament and State Legislatures. B.G. Kher chaired the Official Language Commission, 1955 (a real TNPSC exam fact).

Q: Real exam: Which landmark Supreme Court case dealt with the misuse of Article 356 (President's Rule), and what does Article 370 (in its original form) contain?

A: The S.R. Bommai case (1994) is the landmark judgement curbing arbitrary use of Article 356 to dismiss State governments. Article 370, in the Constitution's original text, granted special autonomous status to Jammu & Kashmir — note: this provision was effectively abrogated by a Presidential Order in August 2019, so treat 'what did Article 370 contain' as a question about the original/historical provision.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Constitution of India is notable for being:

- A. The shortest written constitution in the world
- B. An entirely unwritten constitution like the UK's

C. The longest written constitution of any sovereign country ✓

D. A purely federal constitution with no unitary features

Explanation: Longest written constitution in the world. [easy, web-research]

2. The Indian Constitution is best described, per constitutional scholar K.C. Wheare, as:

A. Purely federal

B. Purely unitary

C. Quasi-federal — federal in form, unitary in spirit ✓

D. Confederal

Explanation: Quasi-federal. [medium, web-research]

3. Part XI of the Indian Constitution describes:

A. The Union Government

B. The State Government

C. Centre-State relations ✓

D. Tribunals

Explanation: Centre-State relations. [hard, question-bank-tnpscgu]

4. Which one of the following is NOT an item in the Eleventh Schedule of the Indian Constitution?

A. Social forestry

B. Health and sanitation

C. Public distribution system

D. Prevention of cruelty to animals ✓

Explanation: Prevention of cruelty to animals is not among the 29 Panchayat subjects in the Eleventh Schedule. [hard, question-bank-tnpscgu]

5. Which Schedule of the Constitution specifies the powers, authority, and responsibility of Panchayats?

A. Sixth Schedule

B. Seventh Schedule

C. Tenth Schedule

D. Eleventh Schedule ✓

Explanation: Eleventh Schedule. [medium, question-bank-tnpscgu]

6. Which language was added to the Eighth Schedule by the 21st Constitutional Amendment Act, 1967?

A. Bodo

B. Nepali

C. Konkani

D. Sindhi ✓

Explanation: Sindhi, by the 21st Amendment, 1967. [hard, question-bank-tnpscgu]

7. Which Schedule of the Indian Constitution deals with the officially recognised languages?

A. Eighth Schedule ✓

B. Fourth Schedule

C. Sixth Schedule

D. Eleventh Schedule

Explanation: Eighth Schedule. [easy, question-bank-tnpscgu]

8. The Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India is responsible only to:

A. The President

B. The Prime Minister

C. The Supreme Court

D. The Parliament ✓

Explanation: Parliament. [medium, question-bank-tnpscgu]

9. Who chaired the Official Language Commission of 1955?

A. Gobind Ballabh Pant

B. B.G. Kher ✓

C. M.P. Jain

D. V.S. Malimath

Explanation: B.G. Kher. [hard, question-bank-tnpscguu]

10. Judicial Review, as a feature of the Indian Constitution, is an important contribution borrowed from:

- A. The UK
- B. The USA ✓**
- C. Germany
- D. The USSR

Explanation: USA. [medium, question-bank-tnpscguu]

11. The Supreme Court's landmark judgement curbing misuse of Article 356 (President's Rule) was delivered in:

- A. Indira Sawhney case
- B. S.R. Bommai case ✓**
- C. Minerva Mills case
- D. Kesavananda Bharati case

Explanation: S.R. Bommai case, 1994. [hard, question-bank-tnpscguu]

12. In its original (pre-2019) form, Article 370 of the Constitution dealt with:

- A. The election process
- B. Emergency declaration
- C. Autonomous/special status of Jammu & Kashmir ✓**
- D. Centre-State financial relations

Explanation: Autonomous status of J&K — note this provision was abrogated by Presidential Order in August 2019. [medium, question-bank-tnpscguu]

13. The Directive Principles of State Policy in the Indian Constitution were adopted from the Constitution of:

- A. The USA
- B. Ireland ✓**
- C. Canada
- D. Australia

Explanation: Ireland. [medium, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Logical Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Logical Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills (Part B Unit II, 10 questions total for the whole unit). Real exam evidence shows TNPSC's 'logical reasoning' label covers a wide variety of puzzle types, not just classic syllogisms — expect position-counting, ranking-from-clues, and direction-sense questions under this same heading too.

Q: Method — syllogism (statements → which conclusions necessarily follow): Statements: 'Some pens are books. All books are rods.' Conclusions: I. All pens are rods. II. Some pens are rods. III. Some books are pens. IV. All rods are pens. Which conclusions follow?

A: Only II and III follow. 'Some pens are books' + 'All books are rods' guarantees that AT LEAST SOME pens are rods (II) and that some books are indeed pens (III, since 'some pens are books' can be reversed to 'some books are pens'). It does NOT guarantee ALL pens are rods (I — only the 'some' pens that are books are guaranteed to be rods) or that ALL rods are pens (IV — nothing says rods can't include non-pen things).

Q: Method — position-in-a-line counting: Richard is 15th from the front in a column of boys. There are three times as many boys behind him as in front. How many boys are between Richard and the 7th boy from the end?

A: In front of Richard: 14 boys. Behind him: $3 \times 14 = 42$ boys. Total boys = $14 + 1 + 42 = 57$. The 7th from the end is at position $57 - 7 + 1 = 51$ from the front. Richard is at position 15. Boys between them = $51 - 15 - 1 = 35$.

Q: Method — algebraic word problem framed as a 'logical' puzzle: 106 trees were planted; non-fruit-bearing trees were 2 more than thrice the fruit-bearing trees. How many fruit-bearing trees were planted?

A: Let fruit-bearing = x . Non-fruit-bearing = $3x + 2$. Total: $x + 3x + 2 = 106 \rightarrow 4x = 104 \rightarrow x = 26$.

Q: Method — ranking from multiple comparative clues: Given several statements comparing four people's scores (e.g., 'Rama scored more than Rani but less than Rathna...'), determine who scored highest.

A: Work through each comparative clue methodically, building a single ordered chain (e.g., Rathna > Rama > Ramya > Rani), rather than trying to hold all comparisons in your head at once — write the partial order down step by step as each clue is read.

Q: Method — meaningful word sequencing: Arrange in a logical sequence: Honey, Flower, Bee, Wax.

A: Flower → Bee → Honey → Wax. The logic: a bee visits a Flower, produces Honey, and the Honey-making process also yields Wax (beeswax) — order reflects the natural/causal sequence of the process, not alphabetical or arbitrary order.

Q: Method — direction sense: A person starts walking, turns left, then turns left again, and is now heading East. Which direction did they originally start in?

A: West. Two consecutive left turns reverse the original direction (left+left = 180° turn), so if they end up heading East, they must have started heading West.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Statements: 'Some doctors are teachers. All teachers are readers.' Conclusions: I. Some doctors are readers. II. All doctors are readers. III. Some readers are teachers. Which follow?

A. Only I and III ✓

B. Only II

C. All three

D. None

Explanation: I and III follow the same logic as the worked example (some doctors are guaranteed readers via the teacher link; some readers are guaranteed teachers by reversing 'some'). II overreaches — not ALL doctors are teachers, so not all are guaranteed readers. [hard, authored]

2. In a column of boys, Meena is 10th from the front, and there are twice as many boys behind her as in front. How many boys are in the column in total?

A. 27

B. 28 ✓

C. 29

D. 30

Explanation: In front: 9. Behind: $2 \times 9 = 18$. Total = $9 + 1 + 18 = 28$. [medium, authored]

3. A farmer planted 84 saplings in total. The number of flowering saplings was 3 more than twice the number of non-flowering saplings. How many non-flowering saplings were planted?

A. 25

B. 27 ✓

C. 29

D. 31

Explanation: Let non-flowering= x . Flowering= $2x+3$. Total: $x+2x+3=84 \rightarrow 3x=81 \rightarrow x=27$. [medium, authored]

4. Arrange in a logical sequence: Seed, Tree, Fruit, Sapling.

A. Seed-Sapling-Tree-Fruit ✓

B. Seed-Tree-Sapling-Fruit

C. Sapling-Seed-Tree-Fruit

D. Seed-Fruit-Sapling-Tree

Explanation: A Seed grows into a Sapling, which matures into a Tree, which eventually bears Fruit. [easy, authored]

5. A person walks north, turns right, walks on, then turns right again. Which direction are they now facing?

A. North

B. South ✓

C. East

D. West

Explanation: Two consecutive right turns reverse the original direction: North $\rightarrow$ (right) East $\rightarrow$ (right) South. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "The House on Elm Street" — Naida Bush

READING MATERIAL

A poem describing an isolated, eerie, possibly haunted house, told through a narrator who feels both curiosity and fear. Real coaching-site evidence focuses on (a) the house's physical description and atmosphere, (b) the narrator's emotional reaction, and (c) figures of speech describing the house as if alive.

Q: Who wrote "The House on Elm Street", and what is the poem's central theme?

A: Naida Bush (spelled 'Nadia Bush' on some coaching sites — syllabus spelling 'Naida Bush' is authoritative). Central theme: a mysterious, isolated house that feels eerie and almost alive, exploring how the unknown provokes a mix of curiosity and fear in an observer.

Q: How is the house's isolation and emptiness described?

A: "It sat alone" — describing the house as lonely and isolated, set apart from other buildings. "Bare to the bone" describes it as completely empty or lifeless, stripped of any warmth or occupants.

Q: What dominant emotion does the poet/narrator express toward the house?

A: Curiosity mixed with fear — the narrator is drawn to investigate the mysterious house but is simultaneously afraid, and per the poem, fear ultimately overtakes curiosity (the narrator does not enter).

Q: What unnatural/spooky details does the poem use to bring the house 'to life'?

A: Lights that flicker on and off (suggesting something unnatural rather than a simple power outage); the house seeming 'a bit brighter' in summer (around May); and a tree beside the house that strangely never grows or sheds its leaves — all small unnatural details that build an eerie atmosphere.

Q: What does the line "It plays with your mind" suggest?

A: Psychological/mental unease and confusion — the house's effect is described as primarily a mental or emotional disturbance rather than a physical threat.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "At night the house seems to be alive."

A: Personification — attributing life/animation to the inanimate house.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "The house seems to be a bit brighter" (in the context of describing the house's mood/behaviour changing with the season).

A: Personification — again attributing a living, changeable quality (mood/appearance shifting like a living thing) to the house.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The House on Elm Street" was written by:

A. Jane Taylor

B. Naida Bush ✓

C. L.M. Montgomery

D. Emily Dickinson

Explanation: Naida Bush (per the TNPSC syllabus spelling; some sources spell it 'Nadia Bush'). [easy, web-research]

2. The central theme of the poem is:

A. A peaceful village

B. A mysterious, possibly haunted house ✓

C. A family gathering

D. A natural disaster

Explanation: A mysterious haunted house. [easy, web-research]

3. What dominant emotion does the narrator express toward the house?

A. Anger

B. Joy

C. Curiosity mixed with fear ✓

D. Boredom

Explanation: Curiosity mixed with fear. [medium, web-research]

4. "It sat alone" implies that the house is:

A. In a busy town

B. Lonely and isolated ✓

C. Overcrowded

D. A guest house

Explanation: Lonely and isolated. [easy, web-research]

5. The phrase "bare to the bone" (describing the house) means:

A. Full of bones

B. Very strong

C. Completely empty or lifeless ✓

D. Covered in skin

Explanation: Completely empty or lifeless. [medium, web-research]

6. Why does the narrator ultimately not enter the house?

A. There are dogs inside

B. It is guarded by someone

C. Fear overtakes curiosity ✓

D. She has no time

Explanation: Fear overtakes curiosity. [medium, web-research]

7. "Lights flicker on and off" in the poem creates an image of:

A. A simple power outage

B. Normal home life

C. Something unnatural and spooky ✓

D. Traffic signals

Explanation: Something unnatural and spooky. [medium, web-research]

8. What is strange about the tree beside the house?

A. It has golden leaves

B. It grows sideways

C. It never grows or sheds its leaves ✓

D. It talks to the house

Explanation: It never grows or sheds its leaves. [medium, web-research]

9. "It plays with your mind" refers to:

A. Physical tricks

B. Confusion and mental unease ✓

C. Educational games

D. Hallucination caused by drugs

Explanation: Confusion and mental unease. [medium, web-research]

10. "At night the house seems to be alive" is an example of which figure of speech?

A. Simile

B. Irony

C. Personification ✓

D. Alliteration

Explanation: Personification. [medium, web-research]